JAMES HARRISON

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Forward Deployed Engineer with 3 years of hands-on experience deploying and maintaining infrastructure across distributed teams. I've worked on everything from Kubernetes cluster management to edge computing solutions, and I genuinely enjoy the problem-solving aspect of working closely with customers in their environments. I'm based in London and prefer roles where I can split time between the office and on-site deployments. I picked up most of my networking knowledge through practical work rather than formal training, which means I tend to approach problems pragmatically.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Director of Infrastructure Operations

TechScale Solutions (Previously known as Axiom Cloud Systems)

London, United Kingdom

March 2023 - Present

www.techscale.com

Directed a team of 28 infrastructure engineers across EMEA region, overseeing all aspects of deployment strategy and customer-facing infrastructure projects

Managed P&L; for infrastructure operations department with annual budget of £2.8M, making strategic decisions on tooling and vendor selection

Architected company-wide disaster recovery framework, reducing RTO from 6 hours to 47 minutes across all critical systems

Designed and implemented automated deployment pipelines using Terraform and Ansible, reducing deployment time by 63% and eliminating manual configuration errors

Mid-Level Systems Engineer

Vertex Innovations Ltd

https://www.vertexinnovations.co

Manchester, United Kingdom

September 2021 - February 2023

Deployed and configured Kubernetes clusters across customer environments in financial services sector, supporting 15+ enterprise clients

Developed Python automation scripts to reduce manual infrastructure provisioning time from 4 hours to 12 minutes per deployment

Managed Linux system administration responsibilities including security patching, user access controls, and performance tuning across 200+ servers

Provided on-site technical support during critical infrastructure migrations, working directly with customer teams to ensure zero downtime

Junior Network Operations Technician

NexGen Infrastructure Solutions

https://www.nexgeninf.io

London, United Kingdom

June 2020 - August 2021

Monitored network performance and system health for mid-market clients using Prometheus and Grafana monitoring stacks

Troubleshot connectivity issues across hybrid cloud environments, reducing mean time to resolution from 90 minutes to 35 minutes

Assisted senior engineers with firewall configuration and network segmentation implementation across customer data centres

Documented runbooks and created knowledge base articles for common operational procedures, improving team onboarding efficiency by 40%

EDUCATION

University of Bristol

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

Graduated June 2020

Bristol, United Kingdom

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Infrastructure & Cloud: Kubernetes, Docker, AWS, GCP, Terraform, Ansible, CloudFormation

Networking: TCP/IP, DNS, BGP, VPN configuration, iptables, firewall management

Monitoring & Logging: Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack, Datadog, CloudWatch

Scripting & Automation: Python, Bash, Go, YAML configuration management

Databases: PostgreSQL, Redis, MongoDB basic administration

Version Control: Git, GitHub, GitLab CI/CD pipelines

Operating Systems: Linux (Ubuntu, CentOS, RHEL), Windows Server administration

Protocols & Services: HTTP/HTTPS, SSH, SSL/TLS, LDAP, NTP

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Solutions Architect Associate - 2022

Kubernetes Application Developer (CKAD) - 2021